

Dono Verification Notice · Dono

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Version 3.0 · Effective 7 August 2026 **Document type:** Notice — information, not contract Supersedes version 2.3 (6 August 2026) and all earlier versions.

This is a Notice, not a contract. It explains what Dono checks and what it does not. It creates no contractual rights or obligations. The operative obligations sit in the Society Campaign Terms.

The short version. Two different things are checked before anyone can raise money on Dono, by two different people.

- **Dono checks student status** — that you control an email address at a recognised UK university. That is the only check Dono performs itself.
- **The Payment Provider checks identity** — using a government identity document and a face scan. **The Payment Provider collects and holds that document and that scan. Dono never receives or stores either.** Dono is told only the outcome, and the verified name and date of birth.

Dono does not contact your university. Dono does not check whether anything in a Campaign is true. **And Dono shows no badges, ticks or "verified" labels anywhere.**

1. Purpose

1.1 The word "verified" means different things to different people, so this Notice explains exactly what Dono checks, what it does not, what others check, and what is shown on the Platform. **Nothing on the Platform should lead a Donor to believe Dono has confirmed more than it actually has.**

2. One review before publication

2.1 **Every Campaign is reviewed by a person against Dono's publication requirements before it can be published.** The review checks only whether the Campaign meets those requirements. **It is not an endorsement, guarantee, audit or certification.**

2.2 The review consists of:

(a) **the student-status check** in clause 3 and the **identity check** in clause 4 — both must be complete before a Campaign can be created, published or receive Donations; (b) **campaign completeness** — that the required fields (clause 7.1 of the Terms of Service, including the Ownership Statement, the itemised budget and the declarations in clause 8.6) are present and internally consistent; (c) **a category and purpose check** — including that a Society Campaign's primary purpose advances the Society's activities, members or legitimate objectives; any primarily external-benefit Campaign is an approved and controlled official Society initiative directly furthering its charitable, educational, sporting, cultural or community mission; and the Campaign is not commercial or a pass-through (clause 8 of the Terms of Service); (d) **a content review** against the Community Guidelines, including full review of any campaign video and of every external link, carried out in the knowledge that campaign pages can be viewed by people of any age; and (e) **for Society Campaigns**, the Responsible Representative's authority declaration (clause 2.2 of the Society Campaign Terms).

2.3 Publication means only that these requirements were met. **It does not confirm the accuracy of campaign statements, the future use of funds, or the authenticity of any supporting document.**

3. The student-status check — university email

3.1 **What Dono checks itself.** To create a Campaign, an applicant must verify that they control a valid email address at a Recognised Institution. Dono currently recognises an ox.ac.uk address or a recognised University of Oxford college subdomain. Dono sends a one-time code or link to that address and requires it to be returned. The applicant also provides their name, declared date of birth, institution and college, course, and expected Course End Date.

3.2 **What Dono does not collect. Dono does not ask for, collect, process or store a student card, an image of a student card, or a student number.** Student-card verification has been removed from the Platform and is no longer part of any Dono process. **Dono also does not store a passport, driving licence, other government identity document or face scan** — where those are required, they are collected and held by the Payment Provider, not by Dono (clause 4). If you are ever asked to upload an identity document *to Dono*, it is not us — please report it.

3.3 **Dono does not carry out "institution verification".** Dono does not contact a university or college to confirm a student's affiliation, and no institution confirms anything about a Campaign to Dono as part of the standard process. Where a Dono document refers to institutional contact, it means the reporting and referral routes in clause 23 of the Terms of Service, which are not part of the publication review.

3.4 **What a completed check does not mean.** It does **not** mean Dono has verified or guaranteed that any campaign statement is true, that any document is authentic, that any cost is accurate or reasonable, that the

Project is viable or lawful in every respect, how the Campaign Owner will behave, that funds will be used as promised, that any institution or society endorses the Campaign, or that the Campaign will succeed. **Donors must form their own judgement.**

3.5 Timing and refusal. Dono aims to complete any manual element within seven Working Days — a target, not a commitment. Dono may request further information (respond within ten Working Days, extension available on request) and may refuse a check where it reasonably suspects fraud, impersonation or circumvention. **A refusal or withdrawal may be appealed within ten Working Days of being notified**, under clause 8 of the Community Guidelines.

3.6 Limitations, stated plainly. A university email address shows that the Institution issued and still maintains an account for that person. It does not prove who is using it at any given moment, and it does not prove current enrolment on any particular course. Dono relies on the applicant's declaration for those, together with reverification (clause 6) and the identity check in clause 4.

3.7 Donor accounts are different. You do **not** need a university email address to hold a Dono account or to donate. Anyone aged 18 or over may create an account with any email address in order to donate, follow campaigns and manage their giving. **The university-email requirement applies only to accounts used to create or operate Campaigns and Societies.** Your account type is fixed when you first choose it and cannot later be switched to a student account without a valid institutional address.

4. The identity check — carried out by the Payment Provider

4.1 What happens. Before a Campaign or Society can be created and published, the person creating it must complete an identity check operated by the Payment Provider's identity service. That check requires a **government-issued identity document and a face scan (a selfie matched against the document).**

4.2 Who holds what. The document and the face scan are **submitted directly to the Payment Provider and are held by the Payment Provider under its own privacy policy, as an independent data controller. Dono never receives, sees or stores either of them.** What Dono receives, and stores, is:

- whether the check passed or failed;
- the **verified name** returned by the check; and
- the **verified date of birth** returned by the check.

Those three items are recorded against the Campaign or Society and are visible only to Dono administrators, for the purpose of confirming that the person raising money is who they say they are. The Privacy Notice sets out how long they are kept.

4.3 A Campaign cannot be created, published or receive Donations while the identity check is pending or has failed. This is enforced by the Platform, not by a manual step.

4.4 The Payment Provider's separate onboarding. The account that receives Donations is a Stripe Connect connected account, and the Payment Provider carries out its **own** identity, know-your-customer and eligibility checks on the account holder, under its own terms and for its own regulatory purposes — not for Dono. Dono does not control those checks and does not receive the documents collected for them. The onboarding status is recorded internally and **is not shown publicly**.

4.5 Age — stated plainly.

- **You must be 18 or over to create an account**, to create or operate a Campaign, to act for a Society, to post a comment, **and to make a Donation**.
- **There is no age restriction on browsing.** Anyone may view a public campaign page.
- **For Donors, age is declared and self-certified, not verified.** Dono asks for your date of birth and, at checkout, asks you to confirm that you are 18 or over and have legal capacity. **This is not highly effective age assurance and Dono does not claim it is.**
- **For people who create a Campaign or Society, the verified result is the final age gate.** A missing, inconsistent or under-18 date of birth blocks creation, publication and receipt of Donations. An apparent error may be reviewed, but Dono does not manually override an under-18 result without corrected Payment Provider data.
- If Dono reasonably believes a Donation was made by a person under 18, **it may cancel or refund it.**

Because children can still reach public pages, Dono has completed a children's access assessment and a children's risk assessment under the Online Safety Act 2023 and an assessment against the ICO's Age Appropriate Design Code, and operates the safety measures described in the Community Guidelines rather than relying on an age restriction it does not enforce on browsing.

5. Society approval

5.1 A Society Campaign is approved through the relevant society page before it is presented as a society campaign, by the Society's Responsible Representative, who gives the authority declaration in clause 2.2 of the Society Campaign Terms.

5.2 One approver is sufficient for Dono to publish. Dono does not require a second person to approve, and the Secondary Contact is not a second approver. **The approvals the Society itself needs are those its own constitution, governing rules, bank mandate and any Students' Union or institutional requirement demand.** Dono neither sets those nor certifies that they were obtained, and may request documentary evidence of authority at any time.

5.3 Society approval does **not** mean the institution endorses the Campaign, that the Society verified its contents, or that the Society is a separate legal person.

6. Reverification and changes in eligibility

6.1 Control of the university email address is reverified each October and at Campaign creation; a check within the preceding three months defers reverification to the next cycle. While reverification is pending and in time, a live Campaign runs normally. Where a university email address stops working, or Dono has reason to doubt a Campaign Owner's eligibility, Dono may pause the Campaign pending a check.

6.2 The **obligations** to remain eligible, to notify interruption, leave or suspension, and to deal with loss of eligibility mid-campaign are in the Student and Society Campaign Terms, not in this Notice.

7. What is shown on the Platform — and what is not

7.1 **Dono displays no verification badges, ticks, shields, or "verified", "validated", "eligibility checked", "trusted", "approved" or similar status indicators**, in any colour, icon or placement, on campaign pages, in listings, at checkout or anywhere else. **Dono presents no interface that could reasonably be read as endorsing, authenticating or guaranteeing a Campaign.** This is a deliberate product decision, not an omission.

7.2 **Eligibility and compliance checks are internal.** The outcome of the eligibility check, the pre-publication review, the Payment Provider's onboarding status, investigation outcomes and internal risk classifications are recorded internally and are **not surfaced to Users** unless the law requires it.

7.3 **The only public state is a neutral campaign lifecycle state** — for example *funding open, funding closed, evidence submitted, evidence outstanding, evidence overdue, closed*. It records where the Campaign has reached in its lifecycle. **It is not a quality signal.** It does not confirm that goods were delivered, that a price was reasonable, that funds were used properly, or that any document is authentic. Receipts themselves are held privately and never shown to Donors.

7.4 **"Institutionally endorsed" is not used.** Dono does not offer or display institutional endorsement.

8. Withdrawal, reporting and contact

8.1 Dono may withdraw an internal eligibility status at any time — for example where eligibility lapses, information proves inaccurate, or the Payment Provider closes a Connected Account. Withdrawal is not by itself a

finding of wrongdoing, and may be appealed within ten Working Days of being notified.

8.2 Anyone may report a Campaign they believe inaccurate or in breach, using the report control on the Campaign or the reporting route available without an account (Community Guidelines clause 7). Dono investigates under the Terms of Service and the Community Guidelines.

8.3 Questions: joindono.team@gmail.com. Dono is a trading name of Amrit Kaur Rooprai, a sole trader, 37 St Giles', Oxford OX1 3LD.